employer, Abdul Khan. He was summoned for a meeting sometime in late January at a safe house on the outskirts of London and for five hours the spies and the mole discussed and reviewed the plan to have Abdul Khan eliminated. Since the successful operation against the network, Tariq had become more helpful and confident. Jindal also enquired whether Abdul Khan was planning to travel to Pakistan. Tariq had no clue. He promised to inform them if there was any such plan. Jindal later flew to Delhi to discuss the idea of eliminating Khan while he was visiting Pakistan.

'This will put enormous responsibility on our assets in Pakistan. I also need to inform the chief and seek his sanction. Remember we need to play by the book/ Bhardwaj cautioned him.

Jindal meanwhile waited patiently for Tariq's information. In the first week of May 1987, Narayanan informed him that Abdul Khan was planning to visit his hometown, Lahore, sometime in June. His plan was to meet the newly appointed ISI chief, Lt. General Hamid Gul. Jindal and Bhardwaj decided that Abdul Khan had to be killed in Lahore. The terror financier was gunned down by two motorcycle-borne men as he entered his house that fateful day in June. He was shot nine times in the head and the neck. The Lahore police believed that the killing was the result of an old business rivalry but the ISI knew it was the R&AW that had chased and killed the fountainhead of terror. At his burial, a R&AW asset noticed that flowers had been sent from Hamid Gul.